

Νόννος ὁ Πανοπολίτης

Dionysiaca and Gospel Paraphrase by Nonnus of Panopolis

eul_aid: tns

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#)

Domain: Ἔπος [Epic](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Nonnus of Panopolis was a Greek epic poet active in the 5th century CE, most likely during the middle or second half of the century. He originated from Panopolis in Roman Egypt, a center known for its blend of pagan, Christian, and Gnostic thought. Beyond this, no reliable biographical details survive.

His two principal works are the *Dionysiaca* and the *Paraphrase of the Gospel of John*. The *Dionysiaca* is a 48-book epic in dactylic hexameter on the life of the god Dionysus. At 21,286 lines, it is the longest surviving epic from antiquity and represents a culmination of the mythological epic tradition. Its innovative, baroque style and influential metrical technique shaped subsequent Byzantine poetry.

The *Paraphrase of the Gospel of John* is a hexameter version of the Fourth Gospel. The co-existence of this Christian work and the monumental pagan epic from the same author remains a central topic of scholarly discussion regarding late antique cultural and religious syncretism. Nonnus is consequently a major figure in the study of late antique literature.

Works (2)

- [Διονυσιακά · Dionysiaca](#) · 21410 passages
- [Παράφρασις εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ἰωάννην Εὐαγγέλιον · Paraphrase of the Gospel of John](#) · 287 passages